THE SESSION · LATE-SESSION READ

Tech Leads, *Oil Firms*

The Nasdaq rose 1.05% and the S&P 500 rose 0.59% as AI-related technology rebounded, while Brent rose 0.67% to $109.52 a barrel. Dividend Strategy +0.44% beat DVY and trailed SPY; Growth Portfolio +1.86% beat IUSG.

S&P 500 ▲ 0.59% NASDAQ ▲ 1.05% DOW ▲ 0.69% VIX ▼ 3.64% BRENT ▲ 0.67%

DIVIDEND STRATEGY — BEAT DVY · TRAILED SPY

+0.44% 1-DAY

FCI		+0.44%
DVY		−0.09%
SPY		+0.53%

YTD **+20.92%** vs DVY +15.64% · SPY +14.27%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO — ▲ BEAT IUSG

+1.86% 1-DAY

FCI		+1.86%
IUSG		+0.68%

YTD **+20.30%** vs IUSG +14.84%

THE SESSION

Stocks rose on Wednesday as a rebound in AI-related technology lifted the Nasdaq, while crude oil firmed on continued Middle East supply concerns. The Nasdaq rose 1.05% to 26,703, the S&P 500 rose 0.59% to 7,758 and the Dow rose 0.69% to 52,856; the VIX fell 3.64% to 16.68. Quarterly results from SpaceX that beat estimates, with its AI segment accounting for more than half of revenue, revived enthusiasm for the AI trade, and chipmakers led. The official 10-year Treasury yield was 5.13%, against 5.12% on Tuesday. Brent rose 0.67% to $109.52 a barrel after settling at $108.79 on Tuesday, as unconfirmed reports of strikes on Saudi energy sites and attacks on Gulf shipping kept supply risk in focus, even as mediation efforts capped the intraday high. IBIT rose 2.42% and ETHA rose 2.47%.

The Dividend Strategy rose 0.44%, ahead of DVY's 0.09% decline by 0.53 point and behind SPY's 0.53% gain by 0.09 point, with seventeen of twenty-five holdings higher and eight lower. Constellation Energy rose 4.60% and added about 0.24 point, while Analog Devices, S&P Global, Broadcom and Caterpillar each added about 0.07 point. Stryker fell 2.23% and subtracted about 0.13 point, Abbott fell 1.84% and subtracted about 0.07 point after its third-quarter report, and Waste Management fell 0.93%, subtracting about 0.06 point. Abbott reported adjusted earnings of $1.42 per share on comparable sales growth of 7.0%, narrowed its full-year adjusted earnings range to $5.50–$5.55 and guided to comparable sales growth of about 6.0%.

Rebounds led by a single theme can fade as quickly as they build, and a firm oil price keeps rate and inflation questions open; owning cash-generative businesses across both sleeves tends to reduce erosion when leadership rotates. ***Think Like an Owner.***

The Growth Portfolio rose 1.86%, ahead of IUSG's 0.68% gain by 1.18 points, with twenty of twenty-five holdings higher, four lower and one unchanged. Vistra rose 3.87% and added about 0.24 point, Credo rose 6.28% and added about 0.24 point, and ServiceNow rose 2.39%, adding about 0.21 point. Full Truck Alliance fell 3.88% and subtracted about 0.12 point, with Harmony Biosciences subtracting about 0.04 point and CNX Resources about 0.03 point. On the year, the Dividend Strategy stands at +20.92% against DVY's +15.64%, a +5.28-point spread, with SPY at +14.27%; the Growth Portfolio stands at +20.30% against IUSG's +14.84%, a +5.46-point spread.

FCI HOLDINGS · NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

CRDO +6.28% GROWTH
Rose to $182.28 as semiconductor names rebounded.

CEG +4.60% DIVIDEND
Rose to $270.74 without a company-specific catalyst identified.

GNRC +4.39% GROWTH
Rose to $203.14 without a company-specific catalyst identified.

VRT +4.22% GROWTH
Rose to $212.15 without a company-specific catalyst identified.

DECLINERS

YMM −3.88% GROWTH
Fell to $8.50 without a company-specific catalyst identified.

SYK −2.23% DIVIDEND
Fell to $297.60 without a company-specific catalyst identified.

ABT −1.84% DIVIDEND
Fell to $100.57 after third-quarter adjusted earnings of $1.42 per share and a full-year comparable sales outlook of about 6.0%.

NTR −1.32% DIVIDEND
Fell to $68.12 without a company-specific catalyst identified.

YEAR-TO-DATE STANDING

DIVIDEND STRATEGY
+20.92%
vs DVY +15.64% / SPY +14.27%
Spread vs DVY **+5.28 pts**

GROWTH PORTFOLIO
+20.30%
vs IUSG +14.84%
Spread vs IUSG **+5.46 pts**

SOURCES

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